

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse



“No eLay,” says Electra

Here's this month's eBay department: last year, actress Carmen Electra—who's in the news after a long time—put up “a date with her” on eBay to raise money for The National Prostate Cancer Coalition. According to British tabloid *The Sun*, she now admits the huge amounts of cash being bid have left her “highly

concerned.” She told an American TV show: “They were bidding for a date with me, which was kind of weird, but the money went to charity, so I thought it would be a nice thing to do. (But) it went up to some crazy number and I actually felt obligated to, like, sleep with the guy.”

He pay for the day, so why the lay?

Blogwash!

Bloggers are a strange breed, and Chinese bloggers are no exception. A peek into the world of Chinese blogging reveals there's some strange goings-on. There are blogs that have nothing in them that qualify them as such.

Take a look at www.1baiwan.com. It's absolutely hilarious—definitely worth a visit, even if it's entirely in Chinese! It features lots and lots of little tiles, and each links to a company or some other entity. Basically, each tile is a mini-ad of sorts; the point seems to be for everyone to grab a couple of



Many such pics do not a blog make

pixels of real estate, ultimately filling up the page. Now who'd want to advertise in a 4x4 space? For some reason, the site is supposed to be a blog.

Another example of Chinese blogs just not cutting it is that of the so-called “Super Voice Girl” Feng Jiamei, who

apparently has a huge fan following in China. And what does she do to draw visitors to her blog? Put up a bunch of sexy photos of her wrapped in a towel while reclining on a bed. The point is, there's not much else on the “blog.”

So what (English-language) non-blogs have you come across?

Smut For Kids

An eight-year-old girl received adult MMS messages from a T-Mobile UK service called Hot Babes. The girl's mother contacted the T-Mobile help desk to stop the arrival of further pictures featuring bare-breasted beauties, but was informed that the company could do nothing: the messages weren't coming from a service using a five-digit shortcode—it had four digits.

Usually, sending “Stop” to any five-digit code cancels any subscription. But the Hot Babes were coming from a four-digit number, and “Stop” doesn't work.

There happen to be ways to stop the subscription, which the helpdesk at T-Mobile wasn't aware of. They've been informed, and are working on it.

We have no idea how the kid got subscribed to the service in the first place.

Podsermons!

In his first Christmas message, Pope Benedict warned against technology, saying people risked ending up in “spiritual barrenness.”

Disregarding that warning, vicars in England are putting sermons on the Internet so parishioners can listen to them on their iPods. According to *The Mirror*, Rev Shannon Ledbetter of St Mary's church, Knowsley, Merseyside, said: “For the elderly and housebound this is fantastic, all you need to do is fix them up with an iPod and they're good to go. For the

young also, there is so much information there, which can help to answer their questions about their faith.” Now, honestly, Rev Ledbetter, how many youngsters will tune their iPods into a sermon?

This piece of news comes just a couple of months after the Bible was translated to SMS-speak in Australia. Many—including the Pope—aver that an obsession with tech goes against the grain of spirituality. But if the people of the world are to choose, they definitely seem to be going the tech way.

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